Up & Down — Operator Guide

For 50pick staff who run the Up & Down game. No technical knowledge required.

Operating rules — read before you begin

1 **Gold trades only on certain days.** Gold and currency pairs are **shut every weekend**: open **Monday 01:00 EAT**, closed **Saturday 00:00 EAT**. While a market is shut the platform will not open or settle a round on it, and the chain reads *market shut*. That is correct behaviour, not a fault.

Crypto — BTC, ETH, SOL — trades 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, including public holidays.

2 **Gold cannot run shorter than 15 minutes.** The duration list greys 3, 5 and 10 minutes for gold and states the reason. Gold's price feed can disagree with itself by up to **$0.20** about a single instant, and by up to **$0.87** across a minute boundary — comparable to what gold moves in five minutes — so a short gold round would be decided by which reading arrived rather than by the market.

Crypto may run any length: 3, 5, 10, 15, 30 or 60 minutes.

3 **The round length IS the betting window, and the result phase is added after it.** A **5-minute** round's betting window is a full five minutes, then a **1-minute result phase** runs in which the closing price is read — six minutes in total. Nothing is taken off the advertised time by the result phase.

But a player cannot use all of it, and you should know the real number. A round is not created until its *opening* price exists, and that price is the completed minute at the boundary, which the source does not publish until it has closed. Measured on production 2026-08-24 over 9,320 readings: the opening price lands a median **91 seconds** after the boundary (never sooner than 60, best ever 72). Those seconds come out of the front of the betting window. So the window a player can actually reach is roughly **the advertised length minus 91 seconds** — about **89s of a 3-minute round**, 209s of a 5-minute one, and 509s of a 10-minute one. Slower assets are worse: XRP's reading lands at 137s, SOL's at 122s. The admin console now says so on any chain running below its asset's advised minimum.

Near the close the result is largely known, so bets must stop before the closing price is read: without that, a player watching the price could bet on an outcome already visible and take money from those who bet at the start. The player's card shows both parts — the countdown relabels itself from "betting closes in" to "result in" and keeps counting through the result phase.

4 **The winning band is the smallest possible step, not a percentage.** The recommended setting, **Smallest possible**, uses the asset's own minimum move: **$0.02** on Bitcoin, **$0.40** on gold — a fraction of what these prices normally move, so **nearly every round produces a winner**. Under the previous 0.50% setting only **63%** of rounds ever paid anyone.

At 0.50% Bitcoin must move ±$316 within five minutes; in testing that refunded every round. A refunded round earns no commission, so a wide band does not increase revenue — it removes it.

5 **A player may hold as many positions as they like, on one side or on both.** There is no per-round cap and no hedging block (owner decision, 14 August 2026).

A player who backs both UP and DOWN takes a real position either way: one leg wins, the other loses, and what they end up with depends on the pools. It is not free money and it is not a loss either — on a lopsided round a small stake on the thin side can pay many times both stakes.

6 **But only ONE side counts toward a bonus.** If a player already holds a position and then backs the other side of the same round, that second stake earns **no** wagering credit toward an unfulfilled bonus.

Nothing to do here — the platform applies it automatically and tells the player before they confirm. It exists because matched stakes on both sides carry almost no risk, so without it a bonus could be cleared for the cost of one leg's commission.

7 **A round that closes late still settles.** Prices come from a **dated one-minute record**, so the price for 13:52 remains available an hour later. If a close is delayed the platform returns to the correct minute and settles, up to **24 hours**. Refunding a delayed round is no longer necessary.

8 **Every refund states its real reason** — six distinct reasons, in English, Swahili and Chinese, on the card, the round page, the settlement proof, the notification and the inbox.

Never describe a refund as "the price did not move" unless that is the reason given on screen.

9 **Rounds are produced manually.** An operator presses **Generate round**; nothing runs on a timer.
While the product is new, a round an operator is watching is worth more than a schedule nobody is watching. Do not start a chain and leave it.

10 **If only one side bets, everyone is refunded.** A round needs money on UP *and* DOWN to produce a winner. A one-sided round returns every stake and earns nothing.
Favour a few chains with players on them over many empty ones.

DO NOT **Do not run gold below 15 minutes. Do not widen the band. Do not open a chain nobody is playing.** These are the three ways this game loses money, and all three appear harmless.

1 · What the game is

A player bets whether a price — Bitcoin, Ethereum, gold — will be **higher (UP)** or **lower (DOWN)** at the end of a short window. One window is a **round**.

1 · Round opens
The price of the last completed minute is read and frozen as the opening price.

2 · Players bet
UP or DOWN. The betting window is the whole advertised length, but it opens only once the opening price lands — a median 91s after the boundary — so a "5 min" round is reachable for about 209 of its 300 seconds, and a "3 min" round for about 89 of 180.

3 · Result phase
Betting stops and the countdown runs on under "result in" while the closing minute arrives.

4 · Round closes
The price for the closing minute is read the same way.

5 · Settlement
UP wins, DOWN wins, or nobody wins and every stake is returned.

THE CENTRAL IDEA **Rounds settle against a dated one-minute record, not "the price now".** Every minute of the trading day has a permanent opening price. "The price at 13:52" means "the opening price of the minute labelled 13:52", and that value never changes. It can therefore be re-checked at any time — which is why a delayed round can still be settled honestly, and why a disputed result can be shown to the player exactly as it was decided.

2 · The price provider, and how it works in our favour

CAPABILITY	WHY IT IS TO OUR ADVANTAGE
The past is readable a dated record, not a live tick	A live price answers only *"what is it now"*; miss the instant and the value is unrecoverable, so any delay had to be refunded. A dated record is the same value hours later, so a late close settles correctly and any player who disputes a result can be shown the exact minute used.
A whole window costs one credit 1–5,000 minutes, one charge	Requesting a window of minutes costs the same as requesting one. Six round lengths on a single asset need roughly **672 separate readings a day**; fetched as windows that becomes **24–96**. Our plan (**Grow**) allows **377 credits per minute**, so cost is not a constraint on how many chains you run — but fewer, larger requests are faster and leave more headroom for retries.
Real-time crypto, currencies and metals	Covers every asset the product needs. It does **not** cover stock indices, and shares outside the United States are end-of-day only — a once-daily price cannot settle a short round, so no non-US share may be used as an Up & Down asset.

TIMING A minute's record is published a **few seconds after** that minute ends — measured between **1 and 10 seconds** across every asset we run. This is why **Generate round** takes its opening price from the last *completed* minute, and why the platform allows up to two minutes before treating a record as missing. That allowance is deliberately generous rather than tuned to the fastest measurement: waiting costs nothing, whereas treating a record as missing refunds a live round. Nothing is required of you; it is simply why generation can take a few seconds to answer.

3 · The assets, and what is distinct about each

ASSET	BAND	LENGTHS	TRADING HOURS	WHAT IS DISTINCT ABOUT IT
BTC Bitcoin READY	**±$0.02** 2 ticks	3 · 5 · 10 15 · 30 · 60	**24 / 7**	Moves whole dollars within three minutes, so almost every round produces a clear winner, and its two price readers agree to the cent. Its band therefore only has to clear rounding. **Begin here**, and use it for any 3-minute round.
ETH Ethereum READY	**±$0.02** 2 ticks	3 · 5 · 10 15 · 30 · 60	**24 / 7**	Behaves like Bitcoin at a lower price, so the same $0.02 band is a slightly larger share of the price and a very quiet 3-minute window is marginally more likely to refund. Reliable at 5 minutes and above.
XAU Gold CARE	**±$0.40** 40 ticks	**15 · 30 · 60 only**	**Mon 01:00 EAT → Sat 00:00 EAT**	The asset requiring most care. Its feed can differ from itself by **$0.20** at one instant and up to **$0.87** across a minute boundary, so its band is **twenty times** Bitcoin's. It is also the only asset that closes, and at weekends the provider continues to publish flat filler prices — which is why weekend gold is refused outright rather than trusted.
SOL Solana CARE	**±$0.02** 2 ticks	②3 · 5 · 10 15 · 30 · 60	**24 / 7**	Usable, and it has paid a real winner. But note the arithmetic: Solana trades near **$74**, so the same $0.02 band is a far larger share of the price than it is on Bitcoin — Solana must move about **0.03%** to decide a round where Bitcoin needs almost nothing. **It will refund more often than Bitcoin on a quiet five minutes**, and its band cannot be made smaller because two ticks is the floor. **Three-minute Solana is offered but marked ②**, with that reason shown beside it — it is a caution, not a refusal, so you may still choose it deliberately; 5 minutes and above is unremarkable. (Gold's short lengths are a different thing entirely: those are ③ and greyed out, because the round would be decided by the feed rather than the market.)

THREE ROWS WERE REMOVED ON 5 AUGUST 2026 If you used this console before that date you will have seen three more assets. They are gone on purpose, and none of them should come back as it was:

- **GOLD** — a **second gold row** carrying the same `XAU/USD` symbol, so the list showed two entries both reading "Gold" and nothing said which one a chain would follow. **Use `XAU`.**
- **SNP500** — an S&P 500 row whose symbol our price plan does not carry at all, and which pointed at a web page rather than the price feed. Every round on it would have refunded. **Stock indices are not supported; do not re-create it.**
- **BNB** — configured under the wrong calendar, so enabling it would have applied gold's weekend closure to a coin that trades daily. If you want BNB, **add it again from the Add-asset list** (8.4), which sets the calendar from the symbol and cannot repeat the mistake.

HOW MUCH COUNTS AS A CHANGE **A movement of one band or more decides the round.** On Bitcoin that is **2 cents**, and a normal 3-minute move is hundreds of times larger — which is why almost every round pays. On gold it is **40 cents**, because the feed's own uncertainty reaches 20 cents and the band must clear it twice over. A smaller band on gold would award rounds to whichever reading arrived first.

4 · How a round resolves

4.1 · The two targets, frozen at open

```
tick   = 0.01                        the asset's smallest price step, at 2 decimals
band   = the LARGER of:  base x margin%       the percentage, if one is set
                         minMoveTicks x tick  the asset's minimum move

UP target   = base + band
DOWN target = base - band
```

On the recommended **Smallest possible** setting the percentage is zero, so the band is always the asset's minimum move. Both targets are **written onto the round at open** and never recalculated: a later change of settings cannot alter a round players have already bet on.

```
Example — Bitcoin, 5 minutes
base         63,856.00
band         2 ticks x 0.01 = 0.02
UP target    63,856.02        DOWN target   63,855.98
```

4.2 · The outcome

```
closing price >= UP target     ->  UP wins
closing price <= DOWN target   ->  DOWN wins
anything between the two       ->  VOID: every stake refunded in full, no commission
```

```
Same round
closing price  63,832.00   which is <= 63,855.98   ->   DOWN WINS
```

4.3 · The money

Up & Down is a pool game: all stakes form one pot, and the winning side shares it in proportion to each stake. Commission is **13% of the LOSING side** — the same charge as long-form markets, in the same words (owner decision, 14 August 2026).

```
pool        = UP money + DOWN money
losing side = whichever side did NOT happen
fee         = 13% x the losing side
net pool    = pool - fee

a winner's payout = round( their stake / winning side's total x net pool )
```

WHY A WINNER CAN NEVER RECEIVE LESS THAN THEY STAKED **The winning side's stakes are never touched.** The fee comes only out of money staked on the outcome that did not happen, so the net pool is always at least as large as the winning side. Where that would not hold, the platform **refuses to settle** rather than pay a winner less than they put in. You will never have to explain such a case, because it cannot occur.

THE FEE NOW DEPENDS ON WHO WINS Under the previous model the commission was the same whichever side won. It is not any more: **13% of the UP pool if DOWN wins, 13% of the DOWN pool if UP wins**. On a lopsided round those two figures are very different, and the admin console shows both before the result lands. *Rounds that opened before 14 August 2026 keep the old model and settle by it — the two are never mixed.*

```
A · a balanced round
UP 5,000 + DOWN 5,000  pool 10,000
DOWN wins, so UP is the losing side:
fee          13% x 5,000 = 650              net pool 9,350
```

```
DOWN's backer staked 5,000 of the 5,000 on DOWN:
payout = 5,000/5,000 x 9,350 = 9,350         commission retained 650

B · an unbalanced round
UP 9,000 + DOWN 1,000  pool 10,000
If DOWN wins:  fee = 13% x 9,000 = 1,170   net pool 8,830
               DOWN's single 1,000 backer receives 8,830 - nearly nine times the stake.
If UP wins:    fee = 13% x 1,000 = 130     net pool 9,870
               the 9,000 receives 9,870. Either way, above the stake.

Note the fee itself: 1,170 one way, 130 the other. The result decides it.
(Every stake here is at least TZS 500, the minimum.)
```

4.4 · The two parts of a round

```
betting runs for the FULL advertised length
result phase   = 20% of the length, rounded UP to a whole minute, at least 1 minute
whole round    = length + result phase
```

ROUND LENGTH	3 MIN	5 MIN	10 MIN	15 MIN	30 MIN	60 MIN
Bets accepted for	3m	5m	10m	15m	30m	60m
Then the result phase	1m	1m	2m	3m	6m	12m
Open to close	4m	6m	12m	18m	36m	72m
Rounds per day	360	240	120	80	40	20

Why the result phase is a whole number of minutes. The closing price comes from a dated *one-minute* record, so a round has to close on a minute mark — there is no record labelled 17:33:36. Rounding the phase up to the minute is what makes the round settleable, not a tidiness choice. It also keeps every span dividing evenly into the 1,440 minutes of a day (4, 6, 12, 18, 36 and 72 all do), so rounds still start on the same clean clock marks each day and several lengths still share boundaries — the saving described in section 2 is unaffected.

When betting closes the player's buttons are disabled, the card states why, and a player who holds a position sees an **exact figure** for each outcome — once the pool is frozen, each side's payout is known precisely. Before that the card shows no payout figure at all: its two buttons say **Up** and **Down** and nothing else (Ali's ruling of 2026-10-14). The countdown then runs again through the result phase under *"result in"*, so the player is never left watching a clock at zero.

WHAT CHANGED, AND WHY Until 2026-08-04 the lead was taken *out* of the advertised time: a "3 min" round ran three minutes end to end and stopped taking bets after 2m24s, so a player got less game than the name promised. Ali's decision was to add the time rather than remove it. The fairness rule is unchanged — nobody can bet in the final stretch before the closing price is read — but the advertised length is now honest *about the result phase*. It is not the whole story: the wait for the OPENING price still comes out of the front of the window (a median 91s — see §2), which is why a "3 min" round is reachable for about 89 seconds. That is recorded as E-194 and the console now states it per chain. One consequence worth knowing: rounds are longer, so a chain produces fewer of them per day (a 3-minute chain now runs 360 rounds rather than 480). Every length except 3 minutes gives players *more* total betting time per day; 3-minute chains give about 6% less, because their 36-second lead has to round up to a full minute.

4.5 · Permitted round lengths

```
a length is permitted only if its WHOLE ROUND divides evenly into 1440, the minutes in a day
3 · 5 · 10 · 15 · 30 · 60   ->  permitted  (whole rounds of 4 · 6 · 12 · 18 · 36 · 72)
4 · 7 · 45                  ->  refused
```

A round that divides the day starts on a clean clock mark, the same marks each day. Several lengths then share boundaries, so one price reading serves many rounds — the saving described in section 2, and section 5 shows a real provider response.

It is the whole round that has to divide the day, not the betting window — since 2026-08-04 the two are different numbers. All six still qualify: 4, 6, 12, 18, 36 and 72 divide 1,440 exactly (360, 240, 120, 80, 40 and 20 rounds a day). The sharing survives too: a 5-minute round's 6-minute span and a 15-minute round's 18-minute span both divide a 30-minute round's 36-minute span, so those three chains still meet on the same instants.

4.6 · If a price cannot be read

```
"not published yet", within 120 seconds  ->  no attempt consumed; retried
retries at 15s, 45s, then 120s, to 4 real attempts
nothing after 390 seconds                ->  VOID, every stake refunded
a delayed close, up to 24 hours later    ->  the correct minute is read and the round SETTLES
```

None of this requires action. It is documented so that when a round reads *confirming price* for a minute or two, you know it is retrying by design.

5 · How the price actually arrives

The platform asks the provider for a **window of one-minute records**. Each record carries the minute it belongs to and four prices; the platform uses the **open**, because that is the single value that identifies "the price at that minute". This is a genuine response for Bitcoin:

```
GET /time_series?symbol=BTC/USD&interval=1min&outputsize=3

{ "meta":   { "symbol": "BTC/USD", "interval": "1min", "exchange": "Binance" },
  "values": [ { "datetime": "2026-08-04 14:37:00",
                "open": "63928.22", "high": "63938.84",
                "low":  "63908.00", "close": "63938.83" }, ... ],
  "status": "ok" }
```

The round stores the record it used, so any result can be re-checked later against the same minute. Nothing is inferred, averaged or estimated.

5.1 · Why nobody wins sometimes — the four causes

"Nobody won" always has one of four causes, and they need **opposite** responses. The reason is recorded on the round and shown to the player.

CAUSE	WHERE IT COMES FROM	YOUR RESPONSE
The price did not travel one full band	Real market behaviour. The close landed between the two targets, so neither side reached a winning boundary.	Nothing, if it is rare. If it is common on that chain, the band is too wide for the asset over that length — set it to **Smallest possible**.
Only one side bet	Not a price problem at all. With no money opposing, there is no pool to pay a winner from.	Consolidate players onto fewer chains. This is the most common cause in a quiet hour.
The price could not be read	The provider did not answer within the deadline, after four attempts across roughly six minutes.	Report it. If it repeats, stop the chain — players are safe, they are being refunded.
The market was shut	A gold round reached the weekend. The platform refuses before it even asks for a price.	Nothing. Run crypto at weekends.

5.2 · Two real rounds, side by side

```
A CLEAR WINNER — Bitcoin, 5 minutes
open  63,856.00      band ±0.02      targets  63,856.02 / 63,855.98
close 63,832.00      moved 24.00 — about 1,200 times the band
result  DOWN.  Pool 1,000. UP lost, so the fee is 13% x 500 = 65;
               the winning 500 paid 935.
```

This is why the smallest band works: Bitcoin routinely moves *hundreds of times* the distance needed, so the result is unambiguous and a winner is paid.

```
NOBODY COULD WIN — gold, Saturday 1 August, four consecutive minutes
provider response, verbatim:
  12:01  open 4042.68240
  12:02  open 4042.68589
  12:03  open 4042.68428
  12:04  open 4042.68445

total movement across four minutes:  0.0035
```

```
gold's band:                          0.40  —  114 times larger
=> ANY gold round over this period refunds. Every one.
```

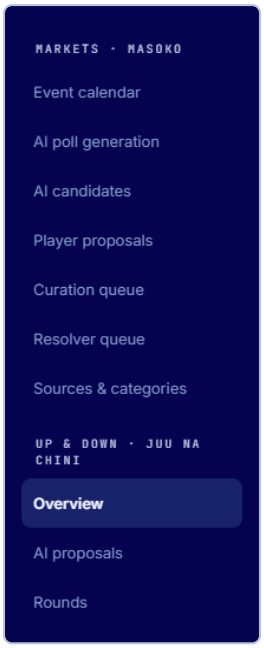
THIS IS WHY WEEKEND GOLD IS REFUSED Note that the provider answered `"status": "ok"` and returned prices that look entirely normal. Nothing in the response says the market is closed. Those are **filler values** — gold is not trading, so the price barely changes, and a round run against them would refund every single time while appearing to work perfectly. The platform therefore blocks weekend gold using its own trading calendar rather than trusting the feed to say so.

5.3 · Why you sometimes cannot create a round right now

When **Generate round** refuses, it creates nothing at all — no round, no stakes, nothing to undo. These are all the reasons, in the order you will meet them.

WHAT YOU SEE	WHY	WHAT TO DO
Could not read a price, immediately after a minute turns	A minute's record is published a few seconds *after* that minute ends — measured at 1 to 10 seconds. Press Generate in the first seconds of a new minute and the record you need may not exist yet; a moment later it does. The platform looks back up to three completed minutes before giving up.	**Wait fifteen seconds and press again.** This is the most common refusal and it is not a fault.
Market shut on a gold chain	Between Saturday 00:00 and Monday 01:00 EAT. Checked before any price is requested, so no provider credit is spent.	Wait for Monday, or run crypto.
Gold offers no 3, 5 or 10-minute option	Gold is limited to 15 minutes and above. The duration is greyed with the reason.	Choose 15, 30 or 60 — or choose Bitcoin for a short round.
The asset is not in the list	It is disabled. A disabled asset cannot produce rounds.	Ask the owner to enable it — that is an accounting control.
Could not read a price, repeatedly, on every asset	The provider is unreachable or the price key is missing. Credit exhaustion is unlikely on our plan, but a burst of rapid retries can hit the per-minute limit.	Report it. Wait rather than pressing repeatedly — rapid retries make a rate limit more likely, not less.
A round already exists for that boundary	One round per chain per clock mark; a second cannot be created on the same minute.	Wait for the next boundary.

6 · Where it lives, and who may do what



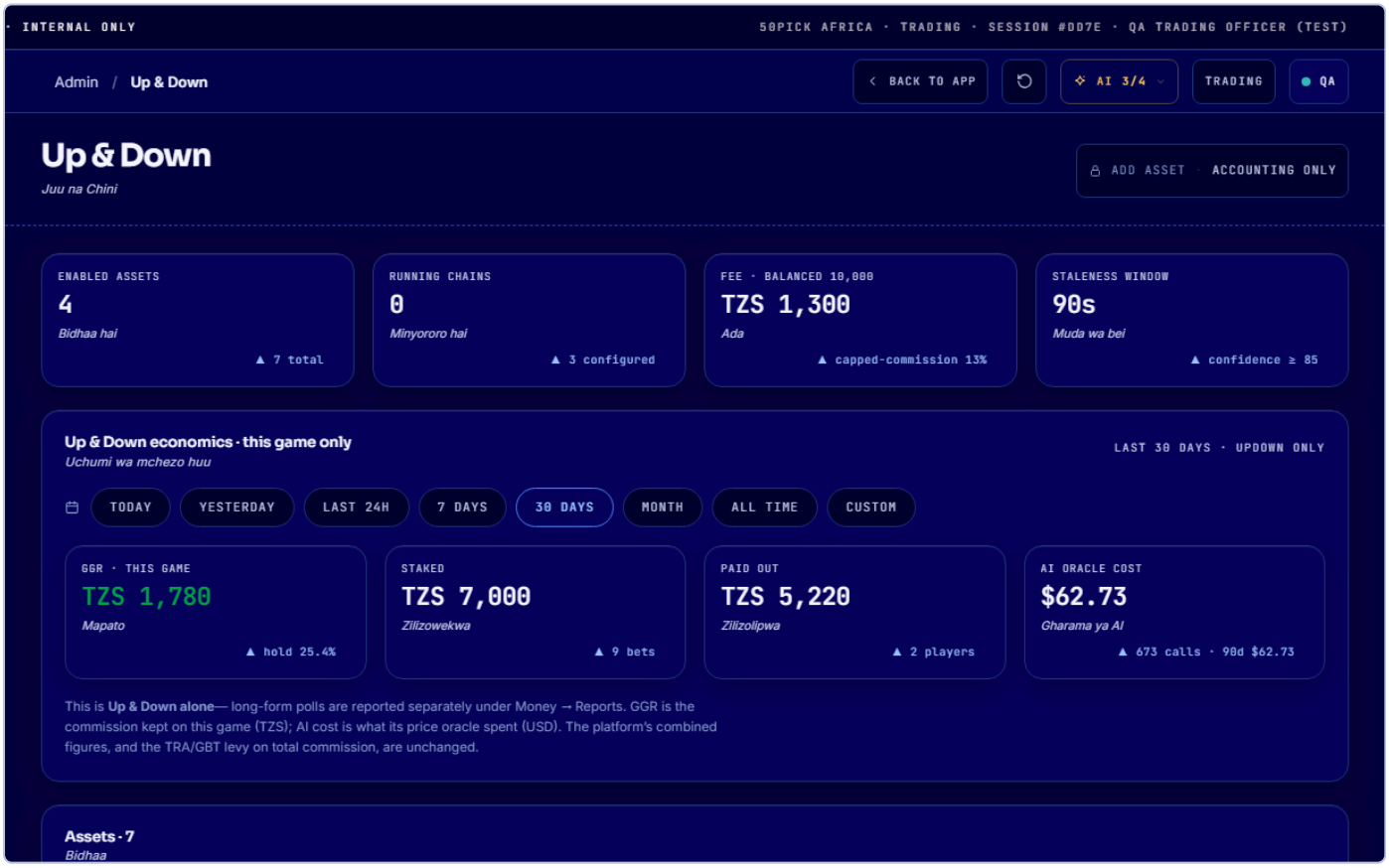
Up & Down is a **separate game** from the polls, with its own section in the sidebar: **UP & DOWN · JUU NA CHINI**. It has three screens — **Overview** (assets and the chains that produce rounds), **AI proposals**, and **Rounds** (every round that has run).

Up & Down rounds do **not** appear under *Markets → Curation queue*; that section is for long-form polls.

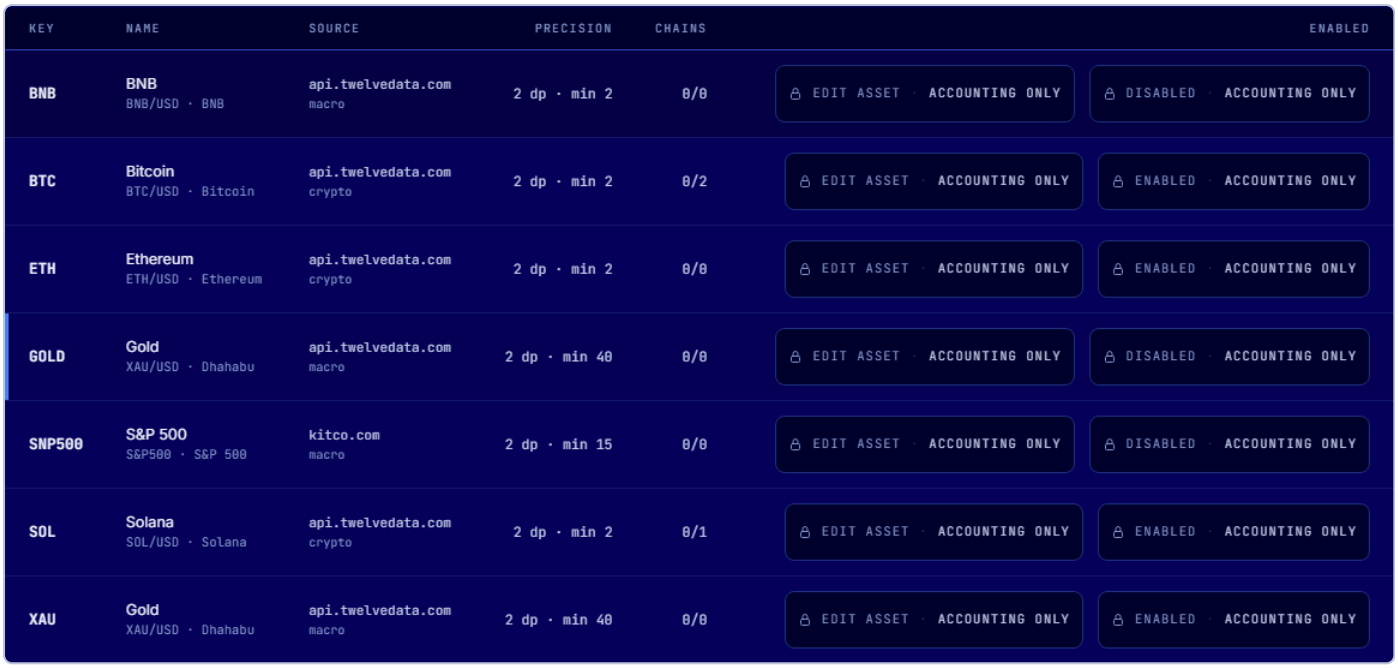
ROLE	MAY
Trading officer	Add, edit, start, stop and **Generate** chains; void a stuck round.
Accounting / Owner	All of the above, plus add and edit **assets** and change product settings.

A control marked 🔒 **ACCOUNTING ONLY** is restricted by design. Assets determine where a real money price comes from, so they are deliberately not a trading-desk control. Ask the owner rather than seeking a way around it.

7 · The Overview screen



Top row: assets enabled, chains running, the commission on a balanced TZS 10,000 pool, and the **staleness window** — how fresh a price must be, currently 90 seconds. **Centre:** this game's money over the period selected. **Below:** the assets and the chains.



PRECISION states the band: `2 dp · min 40` means prices carry two decimals and gold's minimum move is forty of them — **±$0.40**. Note the two entries reading "Gold": use `XAU`, the enabled one. Every control here shows 🔒 **ACCOUNTING ONLY** to a trading officer.

8 · Every field, and what to enter

8.1 · Add chain

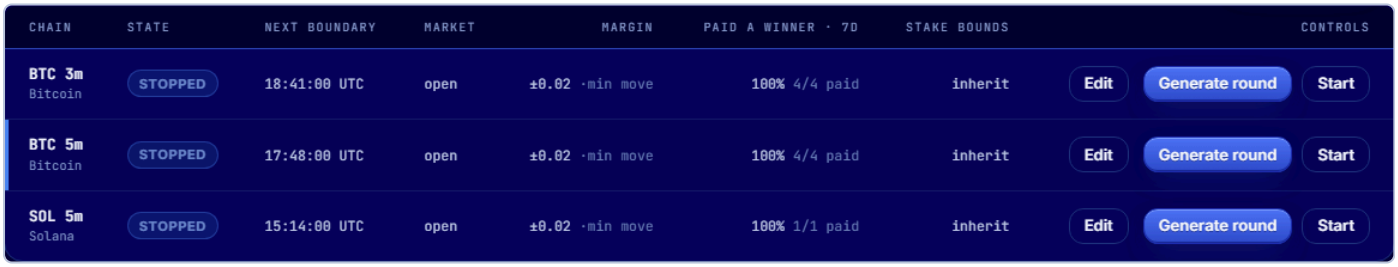


① beside an option means ready; ② usable with a caution; ③ unusable — greyed out *with the reason shown* rather than hidden, so it is always clear why, for example, gold offers no 5-minute option. **From August 2026 these marks are also derived from what the asset has actually done on this platform**, not only from what we know about the instrument — see **8.5**. A ③ is refused by the server as well as greyed in the list, so a pairing you cannot choose here is one that cannot be created by any other route either.

FIELD	ENTER	MEANING, AND THE CONSEQUENCE OF GETTING IT WRONG
Asset	`① BTC · Bitcoin`	Which price the round follows. A list, never typed. ③ entries cannot be selected.
Duration	`① 5 min`	Round length; only permitted lengths appear. Changing the asset re-checks the list — select gold and the short lengths grey out immediately with the reason. *5 minutes is the best length to learn on: long enough to take bets, short enough to see the result while watching.*
Winning band	`Smallest possible`	How far the price must move for a side to win. **Keep the recommendation.** The remaining options exist for a long round on a slow asset: · **Smallest possible** — the asset's minimum move; nearly every round pays. · **Narrow · 0.02%** — roughly 1 round in 3 refunds. · **Wide · 0.05%** — most rounds refund. · **Very wide · 0.50%** — almost every short round refunds and earns nothing.
Min stake	*leave blank*	Blank inherits the product setting, **TZS 500** — the platform minimum. Set it only to raise the floor on one chain.
Max stake	*leave blank*	Blank inherits **TZS 1,000,000**. Lower it on a new chain to limit exposure while it is unproven.

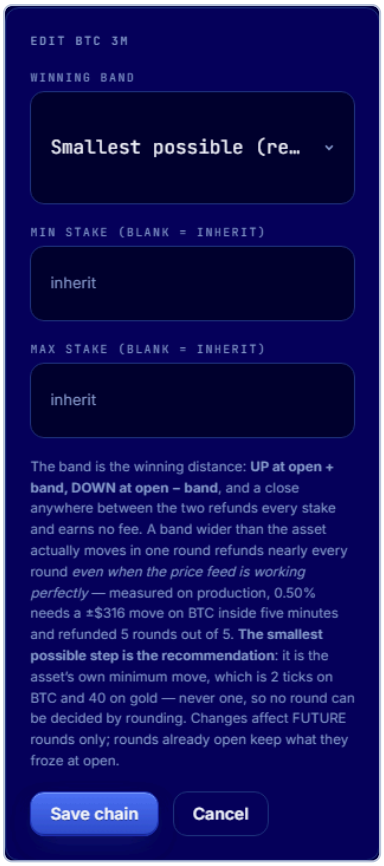
WHY THERE IS NO 0.15% OPTION On Bitcoin at $63,856 a 0.15% band is **±$95.78** — the price must travel almost a hundred dollars within the round for anyone to win. Over five minutes it usually does not, so nearly every round would refund and earn nothing. The list offers only values that mean something: the minimum move, 0.02%, 0.05%, and 0.50% retained as a clearly labelled illustration of too wide. **A wider band does not produce a larger margin; it produces none.**

8.2 · The chain row and its controls



STATE stopped or running · **NEXT BOUNDARY** when the next round would open · **MARKET** whether the asset is trading now — gold reads *shut* at weekends · **MARGIN** the winning band; `±0.02 ·min move` is the recommended setting and means two cents, not "no band" · **PAID A WINNER · 7D** the share of the last week's rounds that actually paid someone, with **—** for no rounds yet. A round that decided but had money on only one side is **not** counted here — it refunded everyone and earned nothing — and is listed underneath as *unmatched*; a round nobody bet on at all is listed as *no bets*, which is a quiet hour rather than a problem.

CONTROL	EFFECT, AND WHEN TO USE IT
Generate round	Creates **one** round now and opens it for betting — your principal control. It reads the opening price from the last completed minute; if no price can be read it refuses and creates nothing, so there is never a round to unwind.
Start / **Stop**	Arms the chain to produce rounds on the clock. **Keep chains stopped for now** and use Generate. Stop allows open rounds to finish normally, so no player is left holding a bet.
Edit	Changes the band and stake bounds, for **future rounds only**.



The Edit panel opens within the chain's own row, so its fields stack. The band is the **same list** as the Add form; it cannot be typed here either.

Inherit follows the product setting, so changing that one setting changes every chain that inherits it. The other choices override this chain alone.

Changes apply to future rounds only. A round already open keeps the band frozen at its open — otherwise the rule a player bet under could be changed after the bet.

8.3 · Product settings — Accounting / Owner only

SETTING	CURRENT	EFFECT, AND THE CONSEQUENCE OF CHANGING IT
Reading method	**Feed**	How a price is obtained. **Feed** is the price provider. *Simulated* invents prices and must never be used with real money; it requires you to type `SIMULATED` to confirm, which is the signal to stop.
Feed provider	**Dated bars**	The most consequential setting on the page. Dated records are what allow a late close to settle rather than refund. The older live-quote option remains only as an emergency fallback. Do not change without the owner.
Fallback margin	**0.00%**	What a chain inherits when its band is set to Inherit. 0.00% means **the asset's minimum move**, not "no band". Raising it widens the band on every inheriting chain at once.
Staleness	**90 s**	How old a price may be and still be accepted. Lower is stricter; too low and valid readings are refused and rounds refund.
Confidence floor	**85**	How certain a reading must be before money is settled on it.
Max attempts	**4**	Real attempts to read a price before the round refunds. A "not published yet" answer within 120 seconds is not counted.
Default min / max stake	**500** / **1,000,000**	The TZS bounds every chain inherits.

8.4 · Add asset — Accounting / Owner only

FIELD	EXAMPLE	MEANING
Asset class	`crypto`	Determines the trading calendar. `crypto` is 24/7; every other class follows the gold and currency week and closes at weekends. It is locked to the symbol, because setting it wrongly once applied a weekend closure to a coin that trades daily.
Symbol	`① BTC/USD`	A list of only the symbols our price plan carries. A symbol the feed does not hold produces rounds that refund indefinitely, which is why it is not typed.
Key	`BTC`	Your short name. **Never renamed** — every report groups by it.
Name EN / SW	`Bitcoin` / `Bitcoin`	What players see, in English and Swahili.
Decimals	`2`	Decimal places carried by the price. Sets the size of one tick.
Min move (ticks)	`2` · gold `40`	The band, in ticks. **1 is not accepted**: a one-tick band is the size of the rounding error on the price itself, so the round would be decided by rounding rather than by the market. The correct figure is measured per asset — see section 3.
Price source URL	`https://api.twelvedata.com/quote`	The approved provider address. Must be `https://`, and its host must already be approved under *Sources & categories*. The path is not significant; the reader supplies its own.

8.5 · The Feed record column — what the round-length gate is reasoning from

Every asset row on **Up & Down** carries a **Feed record**: what that asset has actually done here, measured from every price reading the platform has ever taken. It is what greys the round lengths in *Add chain*, so it is shown to you rather than hidden behind the decision.

YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS
`204 reads · 97% ok`	How many readings this asset has here, and how often one produced a usable price. Below 98% you will see a caution; below 90% the asset is not offered at all, because rounds that refund earn nothing.
`+132s typical`	How long after a boundary a price typically *becomes usable*. This is not the provider being slow — a one-minute bar has to close and publish before it can be read. **A chain does not open a round before its price is known**, so this time comes out of the betting window: on a 3-minute round a 132-second wait leaves players about 48 seconds to bet.
`5m+ advised`	The shortest round length this asset's own record supports while keeping most of its betting time. Shorter lengths still work and stay selectable; they simply say what they cost.
`not measured yet`	**Fewer than 20 readings.** No average is shown, on purpose: a figure from three readings looks exactly like one from three thousand, and acting on it is worse than having none. Start such an asset on a longer round and watch it pay a winner before shortening it.
`no readings yet`	The platform has never read this asset. Nothing is known about it here.

The record can only add caution, never remove it. Gold's 15-minute minimum and Solana's short-round caution come from the size of a price step against the price itself, and from how far the feed disagrees with itself across a bar seam. The Feed record measures neither — it measures *when a reading arrived*, not *how far the market moved while it did*. So a perfect record will never unlock gold at 5 minutes.

9 · Your first live round

The board you have been handed is deliberately empty. Four assets are configured and ready — **BTC**, **ETH**, **SOL** and **XAU** (Gold) — and there are **no chains and no rounds**. That is on purpose: the chains are yours to create, from the steps below, so that the first one you run is one you understand. Every asset therefore reads `no readings yet` in its Feed record (8.5) until it has been run; that is the honest starting state, not a fault, and it fills in on its own as rounds go by.

1. **Up & Down** → **Overview.** Confirm BTC is enabled and reads `2 dp · min 2`.
2. **+ Add chain** → Asset `① BTC · Bitcoin` → Duration `① 5 min` → Winning band `Smallest possible` → stakes blank → **Add chain**. It appears **STOPPED**, which is correct.
3. Confirm **MARKET** reads *open* and **MARGIN** reads `±0.02 ·min move`.
4. Press **Generate round** and wait for the round to appear. If it refuses with *could not read a price*, wait fifteen seconds and press again — you were inside the few seconds before the minute's record was published.
5. Open **50pick.tz/updown** as a player. The board opens on an asset that *has* a chain, at that asset's **shortest** chain length — so with one BTC 5m chain you land straight on it. If you have built several chains and do not see the one you want, check the asset and length tabs before assuming the round is missing.
6. Place a small bet on **UP** and watch **VOL** increase. From a second account bet **DOWN**; both sides are required or the round refunds.
7. When the five minutes of betting are up, watch the buttons disable, the wording change from *betting closes in* to *result in*, and each account that bet see its exact payout for UP and for DOWN. The countdown then runs a further **1 minute** — the result phase — before the round closes.
8. At the close the card shows the result. In **Rounds**, check the outcome, the stake, the number of players and the settlement time.
9. Confirm the winner's wallet increased by the amount the card promised. It will agree exactly.

10 · Refunds — the six reasons, and what to tell a player

A refund is neither a loss nor an error: the player receives their whole stake and no commission is taken. The reason is already on the player's screen, in their own language. **Read it before answering.**

REASON SHOWN	WHAT HAPPENED	WHAT TO SAY
Price did not move enough	The close landed between the two targets. Uncommon on the recommended band.	"The price finished inside the band, so neither side won. Your full stake is back."
Nobody took the other side	Only UP or only DOWN held money, so there was no pool to pay from.	"Nobody bet against you, so there was nothing to win and nothing to lose. Your stake is back in full." Never describe this as the price not moving.
Price could not be read	The provider did not answer in time — our issue, not the player's.	"We could not confirm the closing price, so everyone was refunded rather than guess."
Market was shut	A gold round met the weekend closure.	"Gold does not trade at weekends, so the round could not be settled and everyone was refunded."
Cancelled by us	Staff voided it. The reason entered is recorded permanently.	The truth. Always give a real reason when voiding.
Round expired	No price could be read within the deadline.	"We ran out of time to confirm a price, so every stake was returned."

NEVER **Never quote a price the platform has not confirmed.** Where a screen shows a dash, that is the honest answer. Do not supply a figure from elsewhere — the round did not settle against that source and the player was never told it would.

11 · Daily check

1. **Rounds** — are recent rounds resolving UP or DOWN rather than a run of refunds?
2. **PAID A WINNER · 7D** per chain. On the recommended band this should be high. A low figure caused by unreadable prices is a technical issue — report it. A low figure caused by the price not moving means the band is too wide for that asset and length.
3. **MARKET** — gold reads *shut* at weekends. Expected.
4. **Both sides betting?** A chain whose rounds keep refunding for want of an opposing side has no audience. Stop it and consolidate players onto a busier chain.
5. **Money** — staked and paid out are consistent with the day's activity.

12 · If something looks wrong

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT TO DO
Generate reports **could not read a price**	Pressed within the few seconds before the minute's record was published. Nothing was created.	Wait fifteen seconds and press again. If it fails three times, report it.
Gold chain reads **market shut**	Between Saturday 00:00 and Monday 01:00 EAT.	Nothing — correct behaviour. Run crypto over the weekend.
Price source asked too often	The provider is rate-limiting *us*, not failing. There is a ceiling on how many price reads we may make per minute, and we reached it. **This is not a broken feed and the round is not in danger** — the platform simply waits and asks again.	Nothing, if it clears within a minute or two. It does **not** spend the round's retries and it does **not** cause a refund on its own. If you see it constantly, that is a capacity matter — report it rather than changing any setting.
Rounds keep refunding for want of an opposing side	Only one side is betting.	Fewer chains, more players per chain. A liquidity matter, not a fault.
Rounds keep refunding as **price did not move**	The band is too wide for that asset over that length.	**Edit** the chain → band → `Smallest possible`. Future rounds only.
Confirming price for a minute or two	The retry sequence, working as designed.	Wait. If it never confirms, the round refunds itself.
A round is holding money and will not settle	Something failed for that one round.	**Rounds** → **Void** with a real reason. Every stake is refunded in full.
An asset's price source cannot be changed	A round that captured the old source is still unresolved.	Correct behaviour — those players were told the old source. Let them finish first.
A control reads 🔒 **ACCOUNTING ONLY**	Your role cannot use it.	Ask the owner.

13 · The player's card, field by field — and when each part is visible

The card deliberately shows different things at different moments, which is why two people looking at the same chain can describe different screens. Nothing is missing and nothing is random: each element belongs to a stage of the round. This section is the complete list, so an operator answering a player can say exactly what they should be seeing and why.

13.1 · The five stages

STAGE	WHAT THE CARD SAYS	WHAT IS HAPPENING
OPEN	*Betting closes in* + a countdown	Bets are being taken. The window is the **whole advertised length**, less the wait for the opening price — a median 91s, so a "5 min" round is reachable for about 209 of its 300 seconds.
LOCKED	*Result in* + a countdown, and 🔒 **Bets closed**	The result phase. No more bets; the closing minute has not arrived yet.
CONFIRMING	*Reading the closing price…*	The round has closed and the platform is reading the closing minute's record. Normally a few seconds; it retries by design.
RESOLVED	*Round settled* + **Up wins / Down wins**	A side won. Winners have been paid.
VOID	*Round settled* + the refund reason	Nobody won. Every stake is back in full and no commission was taken.

13.2 · Every element, what it means, and when it appears

ON THE CARD	WHAT IT MEANS	VISIBLE WHEN
VOL · TZS n	**The total staked in this round, both sides added together.** Not a payout, not a balance, and not per-player. It is how much money the round is playing for.	**Always.** It reads `TZS 0` until the first bet.
The number beside the **people icon**	How many **separate accounts** hold a position in this round — not how many bets. One account betting twice on the same side is still 1.	Always.
Up 60% / 40% Down	How the money is split, **by stake, not by number of players**. It is the share of the money on each side — not odds, and not what a winner is paid.	**Only when both sides hold money.** With money on one side the bar is a dashed rail named *"One side only"*; on an untouched round it is the empty rail alone. It never shows an even 50/50 for a pool nobody has backed.
Higher or lower than $X and **± $0.02**	The **opening price** the round is judged against, and the size of the winning band.	Open, Locked and Confirming. **Hidden once the round settles** — it shows its outcome instead — and absent entirely if no opening price was ever confirmed.
UP ≥ $A and **DOWN ≤ $B**	The two targets, frozen at open and never recalculated. The close must reach one of them for that side to win.	Same as above.
500 · 1K · 2.5K · 5K · Custom	The stake to be used by the next tap. It is a chooser, not an amount already bet.	**Only while betting is open.**
Up / **Down** (the two buttons)	⭐ **The two choices, and nothing else.** Since Ali's ruling of 2026-10-14 ("keep up and down only") they carry **no number** — no multiplier and no estimate. A player who wants to know what a stake would return sees it at the moment of betting: the round page's confirm panel (*"TZS 500 → TZS 634"*) and the bet receipt (*"Projected return"*), an estimate from the pool at that moment, which moves as other people bet.	**Only while betting is open.** If a player asks where the multiplier went: it was removed from every Up & Down card on purpose; the projected return at the moment of betting is the figure to point to.
Nobody has backed Down yet — if that does not change, your stake comes back.	One side of the round holds no money, so if betting closed now nobody could win and every stake would come back in full. A fact about the round, not an estimate.	**Only while betting is open, and only while a side is empty** — it disappears the moment both sides hold money.
You're in UP · TZS 1,000	What *this* player already has on this round.	Once they have bet.
🔒 **Bets closed at 09:40:00 — the result is locked…**	Why the buttons stopped working, with the exact instant. The round is running normally.	**Only in the result phase.**
If it closes UP · TZS 1,740 / **If it closes DOWN · TZS 0**	⭐ **The EXACT figures**, not estimates — what this player receives under each outcome. Once betting closes the pool is frozen, so the payout is known precisely; a player who backed one side sees 0 on the other line, which is simply true.	**Only in the result phase, and only if the player holds a position.** It is the first payout figure the card ever shows.
Reading the closing price…	The closing record is being fetched. The platform never settles on a guess.	Only while confirming.

Up wins · $64,344.00 → $64,379.29	The outcome with the two prices that decided it.	Only once resolved, and only when both prices exist.
Live crypto market · quoted 18:37:00 · Open $64,326.01	Which minute's record was used, and the opening price taken from it. This is the line to quote to a player who disputes a result.	Whenever an opening price was confirmed.

WHAT "VOID" MEANS, IN ONE SENTENCE Nobody won, so **every stake is returned in full and the platform takes no commission** — it is not a loss, not a penalty and not an error. Six different things can cause it and the card always names the real one; §10 lists all six and what to say. ⛔ Never describe a void as "the price did not move" unless that is the reason printed on the screen — "nobody took the other side" is a completely different situation and the player will know the difference.

WHY THE CARD LOOKS DIFFERENT EACH TIME YOU LOOK Because a round moves through five stages in a few minutes and each stage shows what is true at that stage. While betting is open the card shows no payout figure; the exact figure appears the moment it stops changing; the targets give way to the result. If a player says a number "disappeared", the answer is almost always that the round moved on — ask which stage the card is showing, using the first table above.

14 · Testing it yourself — how to prove each outcome on purpose

Everything below is something you can make happen deliberately, on the real platform, in a few minutes. **Do not wait to discover these for the first time when a player asks about one.** Each test tells you what to do, what you should see, and how to put things back.

Before you start — four rules that keep a test a test.

1. **Use your own test account, and small stakes.** This is the live platform. The money is real, it moves for real, and it lands in a real wallet.
2. **Change one thing at a time.** If you widen a band and stop a chain together, you will not know which one caused what you see next.
3. **Put it back.** Every test below ends with a restore step. A band left wide is a chain that refunds every round for as long as it is forgotten.
4. **A round keeps the settings it opened with.** Change a band and the round already running is unaffected — your change lands on the *next* one. Watching the wrong round is the most common reason a control looks broken when it is not.

14.1 · Prove a normal round pays a winner

1. Create a **BTC 5 min** chain, band `Smallest possible`, and press **Generate round**.
2. On **50pick.tz/updown**, back **UP** from one account and **DOWN** from another. Both sides must hold money or the round refunds for want of an opposing side (14.3).
3. Wait for the round to close, then the result.

You should see: one side marked won, the other lost. The winner's wallet rises by the payout; the loser's fell by the stake when they bet. Open the round and read the **Settlement proof**: the open price, the close price, both targets, and the times each price was quoted and observed. **Every figure a player can question is on that panel.**

Check the money to the shilling. Wallet before, wallet after, and the payout shown on the card should agree exactly. If they do not, stop and report it — do not run another round on that chain.

14.2 · Force a *price did not move enough* refund

1. **Edit** the chain → **Winning band** → `Very wide · 0.50%` → save.
2. Wait for the **next** round to open (the one running keeps the old band), and back a side.

You should see: the round resolves as a refund. On Bitcoin, 0.50% is roughly a **$320** move required inside three minutes — which almost never happens, which is the point. The player's card reads *"The price did not move far enough either way…"* and the stake is returned in full.

Put it back: Edit → band → `Smallest possible`. ⛔ Leaving it wide means every future round on that chain refunds and earns nothing.

14.3 · Force a *nobody took the other side* refund

1. On a live round, back **one side only**, from one account, and let it settle.

You should see: the round **decides normally** — it will say UP or DOWN — and your stake still comes back in full. The card reads **Stake returned** and explains: *"Nobody backed the other side, so there was nothing to win and nothing to lose."*

⚠️ **This is the one most easily explained wrongly.** The round was not void and the price did move — there was simply no counterparty, so there was no pool to be paid from. The card must never call it a void and must never suggest the player lost. If you ever see it do either, report it.

14.4 · Force a *cancelled by us* void

1. **Up & Down** → **Rounds**, find a round that is still running, press **Void & refund**.
2. Type a real reason. It is required, and it is kept permanently against your name.

You should see: every stake refunded in full, no fee taken, and the player's card reading *"This round was cancelled by our team."* The **Void & refund** button disappears from that row, because a settled round cannot be voided twice.

Only do this for a real reason. The entry is permanent, it carries your name, and "testing" is a reason a regulator can read later.

14.5 · See the market-shut state

Try to run a **gold** round between **Saturday 00:00 and Monday 01:00 EAT**. The platform refuses to open or settle one and says so. Nothing is wrong: gold does not trade at weekends. During the week you cannot produce this state at all — which is itself worth knowing before you go looking for it.

14.6 · Watch the Feed record fill in

A brand-new asset reads `no readings yet`, then `not measured yet` while it has fewer than twenty readings, and only then starts showing a success rate and a typical wait (8.5). **Run a chain for an hour and watch the column change.** That is the platform learning the asset, and it is what decides which round lengths it will offer you later.

14.7 · The checks worth doing after ANY change

CHECK	WHY
PAID A WINNER · 7D on the chain row	The single most useful number on the page. A healthy chain pays winners. A low figure caused by unreadable prices is a technical problem; a low figure caused by the price not moving means the band is too wide.
The breakdown beside it	The reasons are listed separately — *unmatched*, *no bets*, *no-move*, *source-failed*, *operator* — precisely so you can tell a thin chain from an empty one from a wide band from a broken feed from your own team's actions. One blended percentage would hide all five. **unmatched** is 5.1's second cause: the round decided perfectly well and paid nobody because only one side had money in it — that is the number that tells you to consolidate players onto fewer chains. **no bets** is different and must not be confused with it: nobody staked anything at all, so nothing was paid *and* nothing was refunded. Neither counts as having paid a winner.
Wallet vs the card	Money is the only claim that cannot be argued with. Check it to the shilling.
The player's own language	Switch to **SW** or **中文** and re-read the result. Every reason exists in all three; if one falls back to English, report it.

15 · Terms

TERM	MEANING
Asset	Something with a price — Bitcoin, Ethereum, gold.
Chain	One asset at one length. "BTC 5m" is one chain, and it produces rounds.
Round	One window players bet on.
Band	How far the price must move for a side to win — `±0.02` on Bitcoin.
Tick	The smallest step a price can take. At two decimals, one tick is 0.01.
Boundary	The clock mark where one round ends and the next begins.
VOID	No winner. Every stake refunded in full, no commission taken.
Pool	All money staked on a round.
GGR	What the platform retains: staked less paid out.
Staleness window	How old a price may be and still be accepted — 90 seconds.

IF IN DOUBT **Stop the chain.** Stopping prevents new rounds and lets open ones finish normally, so no player is left holding a bet. It is always safe, needs no technical help, and is reversed in one click.